

- **Store loyalty cards:** Advances in technology have prompted grocery stores to offer more innovative ways for their customers to save money. Some offer club membership discounts or store savings cards, which also allows the store a handy way of tracking consumer purchases. Other stores offer a savings that can be loaded onto a card from the customer's home computer.
- **Mobile coupons:** One of the fastest growing types of coupons used today is the mobile coupon, or a coupon that is offered via a text message. The new coupon-savvy consumer doesn't even have to use a scissors for their savings.
- **Online shopping discount codes:** The coupon codes are a combination of numbers and/or letters that can be entered into a promotional code section on an online order form, offering a savings that is deducted from the total purchase at checkout.

There are those in the industry who argue that paper coupons are a thing of the past, despite evidence to the contrary. Coupons have been around since the nineteenth century and are a part of most consumers' lives. Obviously, from current trends and in tough economic times, the mighty coupon has become a means of saving money, even for those who don't normally clip them.

What happens if manufacturers don't respond to the consumer demand for more coupons, or worse, withhold what has been one of the consumer's favorite promotions? Is couponing still an effective promotional strategy?

Let's look to Procter & Gamble to answer that question. In January of 2001, the *Journal of Marketing* published a study on the effects of Procter